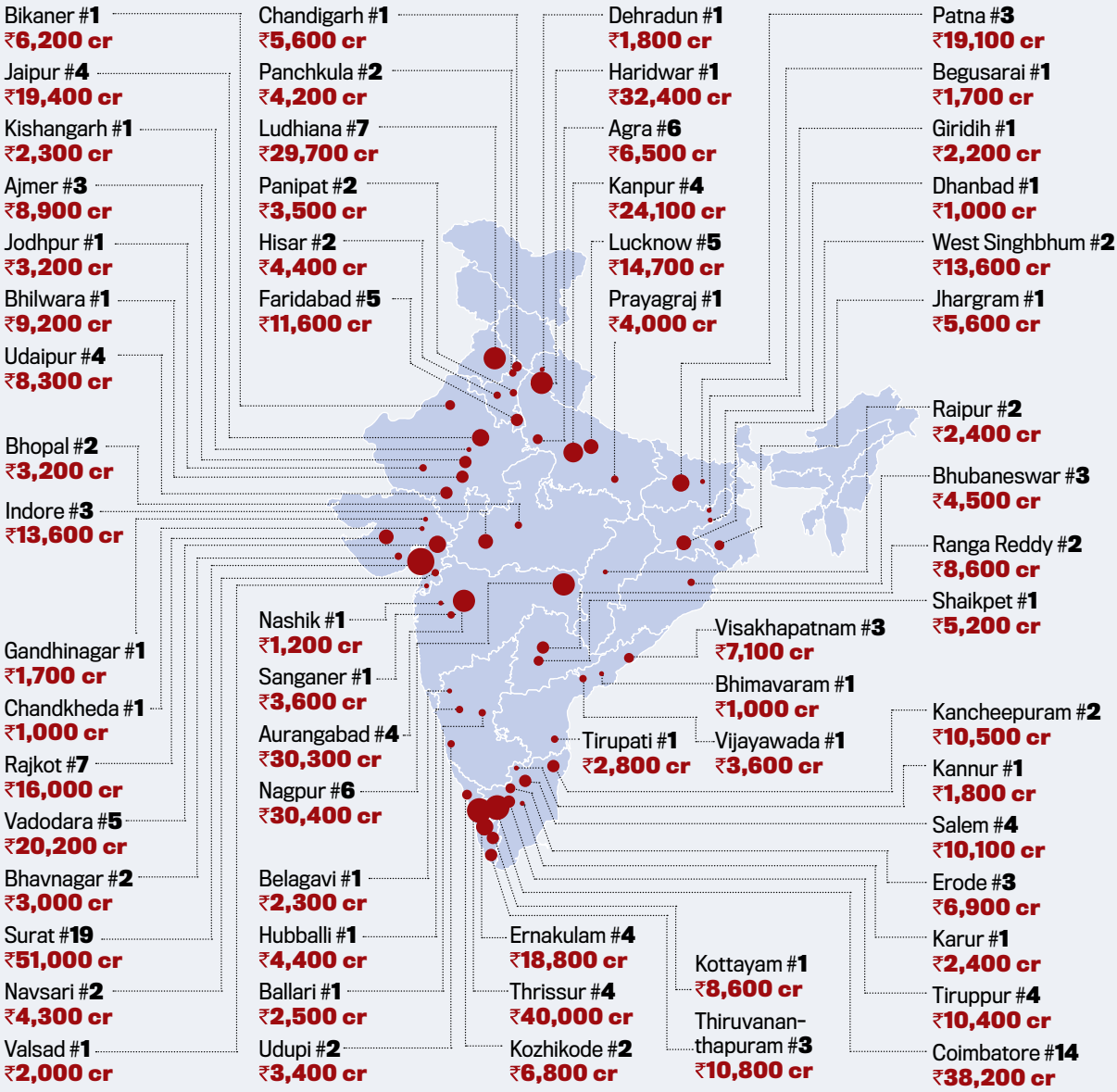
A RICH COUNTRYSIDE

INDIA'S SMALLER CITIES HAVE GIVEN US 178 TYCOONS WHOSE NET WORTH EXCEEDS Rs 1,000 CRORE. THAT COIMBATORE AND SURAT HAVE THE MOST IS NO SURPRISE, THRISSUR IS THE WEALTHIEST

Total wealth generated
₹6,37,800 cr

Name of the small town
#**No. of wealth generators**
Wealth generated



Source: IIFL Wealth Hurun India Rich List 2022

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

in the years after liberalisation made glistening cities out of once laidback Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Pune too. Not just Indian corporations but also multinational companies eager for a slice of India's fast-growing consumer market set up home in these neo-metropolises. But away from the spotlight, in India's relatively smaller cities such as Ajmer in Rajasthan, Udupi in Karnataka, Indore in Madhya Pradesh, Surat in Gujarat or Bhubaneswar in Odisha, another set of entrepreneurs were quietly but surely carving out a unique business presence. They bought up massive stretches of land, set up world-class facilities, created millions of jobs and changed not just their own fortunes but also of the places they came from, bringing to them schools, malls, healthcare facilities and infrastructure. Today, private equity players and venture capitalists line up outside their doors to support new ventures and invest a part of their wealth in future enterprises. "India is seeing a very exciting phase, where innovation is moving deeper into the country, beyond the metros and Tier I cities," says Vikram Gandhi, a senior lecturer at the Harvard Business School and co-founder at Asha